



Dr Jayashree L S - PSGCT <lsj.cse@psgtech.ac.in>

Request for Review: Investigating the Use of Blockchain Technology to Enable Farm-to-Fork Traceability of Organic Produce

PCS <proofofconcept@mric.mu>

To: "lsj.cse@psgtech.ac.in" <lsj.cse@psgtech.ac.in>

Cc: Dr N Gopaul <nitingopaul@mric.mu>

Mon, Mar 6, 2023 at 11:19 AM

06 March 2023

MRIC/PCS-A64

Professor Jayashree L S

Computer Science Engineering

PSG College of Technology

India

Dear Professor Jayashree,

Request for Review: Investigating the Use of Blockchain Technology to Enable Farm-to-Fork Traceability of Organic Produce

The purpose of this e-mail is to request your assistance in reviewing a proposal that has been received by the Mauritius Research and Innovation Council (MRIC), titled "Investigating the Use of Blockchain Technology to Enable Farm-to-Fork Traceability of Organic Produce".

The MRIC is an apex body advising the Government of Mauritius on all matters pertaining to science and technology, as well as social and economic issues. A fundamental part of the MRIC's mandate involves providing support for innovative research, which it undertakes through a number of innovation and commercialisation grant schemes. In this context, we have recently received the above-mentioned proposal for which funding has been requested under the Proof of Concept Scheme.

In the interest of ensuring that high standards of innovative research are maintained, the MRIC evaluates the proposals it receives for funding through a process which includes review by an expert, especially in areas where the MRIC has limited experience.

The MRIC would therefore like to request your assistance in reviewing the above-mentioned proposal and in providing a critical and objective judgement of the intended innovative research.

Please find below, for your attention, a copy of the project summary.

APPENDIX C

Proof of Concept Scheme

Project Leader Name: M ISABELLE DOMIJAN BOWLER	
Address: Robert Antoine Building, Reduit, Moka	The information on this form may be made public.
Enterprise / Company / Institution: Société Omnicane, Alteo et Terra (Regional Training Centre)	
Project Title: Investigating the use of blockchain technology to enable farm-to-fork traceability of organic produce	
TECHNICAL ABSTRACT (200 words or less)	Include Potential Commercial Applications
Due to the increasing demand for organic produce in Mauritius and the risks of fraud in this currently small market, it has become paramount to develop a reliable system to trace and authenticate organic produce from the producer to the consumers. This feasibility study aims at investigating the potential of a blockchain-based system to increase the transparency and efficiency of an organic supply chain; the costs related to this innovative technology will also be analysed. To achieve traceability of an organic produce, a distributed electronic ledger will be created containing a series of linked blocks, where each block describes an information state upon which the majority of all network participants agreed. Cryptographic signatures and hashes are used to ensure the authenticity of each transaction and the integrity of all blocks. The prototype developed will ensure information in terms of transactions to be stored chronologically, irrevocably and unalterably in a digital network. The prototype will be assessed for its applicability and the cost incurred by the producer and consumer will also be assessed to analyse the potential of this technology for use on a larger scale.	
Key Words to Identify Research (8 maximum)	
organic certification, blockchain, decentralised network, traceability, provenance, supply chain	

We should be grateful if you could indicate whether you would be agreeable to review this proposal. Please let us know whether there is any ***potential conflict of interest*** that may arise in undertaking this review.

Should you agree to undertake the review:

- (1) the complete proposal and the evaluation sheet will be forwarded to you;
- (2) the review is expected to be submitted within two weeks of receipt of proposal;
- (3) a token fee of MUR 4,000 (approx. USD88) will be provided to you upon completion of the review;
- (4) you are requested to provide a preferred contact number and a copy of your updated CV to the MRIC.

Alternatively, you may wish to propose another expert whom you believe would be able to assist us in undertaking the review.

It would be appreciated if you could inform us of your decision by **Wednesday 08 March 2023**. Kindly provide us with a signed copy of the confidentiality agreement together with your reply, if you are agreeable to carry out the review.

We thank you for your time and consideration and look forward to hearing from you.

Kind regards,

Ms H Keenoo

For Dr N Gopaul

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PCS.009 Reviewer Confidentiality Agreement Form Issue 2 Rev 0.docx
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